

STUDENT NOTES



MEMBERSHIP

LOVE GOD. LOVE PEOPLE.

metanoya

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MEMBERSHIP 101: WELCOME TO METANOYA

101: WELCOME TO METANOYA

“So now you Gentiles are no longer strangers and foreigners. You are citizens along with all of God’s holy people. You are members of God’s family.” Ephesians 2:19 (NLT)

The church isn't simply a building you visit. **The church is a family you belong to.** When you put your faith in Jesus, you become part of God's family. God also designed us to grow alongside other believers in a local church. That's what membership is about. It's saying: **“This is my church family. This is where I will grow, build relationships, serve, and help reach people for Jesus.”**

Today we're going to answer three questions:

| **01** WHERE DID WE COME FROM: *Our Story*

| **02** WHY ARE WE HERE: *Our Mission*

| **03** WHAT DO WE BELIEVE: *Our Beliefs*

1. WHERE DID WE COME FROM? | *Our Story*

- ▶ Before there was a Metanoya Church, there was a miracle. Our founders, Pastor Freddie and Ninfa Garcia, had been trapped in addiction to drugs and alcohol. In 1966, while in Los Angeles, California, Jesus Christ transformed their lives. They returned to San Antonio believing: “If Jesus could change us, He can change anybody.” In 1970, they opened their home to people struggling with addiction. People were saved. Lives were changed. Families were restored. And so, in 1970, our Outcry Home was born.

- ▶ But many local churches weren't prepared to welcome people coming out of addiction and brokenness. So on Mother's Day in 1973, Metanoya Church was born—a church where anyone could come and discover the hope of Jesus.
- ▶ In 2004, when Pastor Freddie retired, Pastor Jubal Garcia was chosen by our Board of Directors to lead the ministry. A lot has changed since 1973. But our heartbeat hasn't. OUR MESSAGE IS SIMPLE: There is hope, and His name is Jesus. No one is too far gone. Jesus still saves. Jesus still changes lives. And that's why Metanoya Church exists.

2. **WHY ARE WE HERE?** | *Our Mission*

- ▶ Our mission comes from the mission of Jesus: ***“For the Son of Man came to seek and save those who are lost.” Luke 19:10 (NLT)***
- ▶ Metanoya exists to reach people who are far from God and help them find new life in Jesus Christ. We want to be a church for the unchurched, a place where people who don't normally attend church, have questions, are struggling, or feel far from God can discover the hope of Jesus. That's why we make the Bible easy to understand, talk about real-life issues, and work hard to make people feel welcome. **We're not trying to build a bigger church. We just want to reach one more soul.**

OUR FIVE PURPOSES:

Our mission tells us why we exist. Our five purposes help us understand How We Accomplish our Mission?

1. _____
— **We Worship God.**

- ▶ *“²³But the time is coming—indeed it’s here now—when true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth. The Father is looking for those who will worship him that way. ²⁴For God is Spirit, so those who worship him must worship in spirit and in truth.” John 4:23–24 (NLT)*
- ▶ We gather to worship God and help people know Him.

2.

— We Build Relationships with God’s Family.

- ▶ *“All the believers devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching, and to fellowship, and to sharing in meals (including the Lord’s Supper), and to prayer.” Acts 2:42 (NLT)*
- ▶ We encourage one another and walk through life together.

3.

— We Grow In Our Faith.

- ▶ *“¹⁹Therefore, go and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit. ²⁰Teach these new disciples to obey all the commands I have given you. And be sure of this: I am with you always, even to the end of the age.” Matthew 28:19–20 (NLT)*
- ▶ We learn God's Word and become more like Jesus.

4.

— We Serve Others.

- ▶ *“God has given each of you a gift from his great variety of spiritual gifts. Use them well to serve one another.”
1 Peter 4:10 (NLT)*
- ▶ God has given every believer gifts and opportunities to serve.

5. _____

— **We Reach The Lost.**

- ▶ *¹³ For “Everyone who calls on the name of the LORD will be saved.” ¹⁴ But how can they call on him to save them unless they believe in him? And how can they believe in him if they have never heard about him? And how can they hear about him unless someone tells them? Romans 10:13–14 (NLT)*
- ▶ We tell others about Jesus and reach people are far from God.

3. WHAT DO WE BELIEVE? | *Our Beliefs*

At Metanoya: The Bible is our final authority for what we believe and how we live. Here are ten foundational truths we believe:

WE BELIEVE IN _____.

- ▶ There is one God who eternally exists as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.
- ▶ *“Therefore, go and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit.”
Matthew 28:19 (NLT)*

WE BELIEVE IN _____.

- ▶ Jesus is fully God and fully man. He lived without sin, died for our sins, rose from the dead, and is alive today.
- ▶ *“In the beginning the Word already existed. The Word was with God, and the Word was God.” John 1:1 (NLT)*
- ▶ *“So the Word became human and made his home among us. He was full of unfailing love and faithfulness. And we have seen his glory, the glory of the Father’s one and only Son.” John 1:14 (NLT)*
- ▶ *“³ I passed on to you what was most important and what had also been passed on to me. Christ died for our sins, just as the Scriptures said. ⁴ He was buried, and he was raised from the dead on the third day, just as the Scriptures said.” 1 Corinthians 15:3–4 (NLT)*

WE BELIEVE IN _____.

- ▶ The Holy Spirit is God. He lives in believers, guides us, transforms us, and empowers us to live for God.
- ▶ *“When the Spirit of truth comes, he will guide you into all truth. He will not speak on his own but will tell you what he has heard. He will tell you about the future.” John 16:13 (NLT)*
- ▶ *“But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes upon you. And you will be my witnesses, telling people about me everywhere—in Jerusalem, throughout Judea, in Samaria, and to the ends of the earth.” Acts 1:8 (NLT)*

WE BELIEVE _____.

- ▶ Every person is created by God with value and purpose
- ▶ *"So God created human beings in his own image. In the image of God he created them; male and female he created them."*
Genesis 1:27 (NLT)

WE BELIEVE _____.

- ▶ Every person has sinned and needs a Savior.
- ▶ *"For everyone has sinned; we all fall short of God's glorious standard."* *Romans 3:23 (NLT)*
- ▶ *"When Adam sinned, sin entered the world. Adam's sin brought death, so death spread to everyone, for everyone sinned."*
Romans 5:12 (NLT)

WE BELIEVE _____.

- ▶ Salvation is God's gift, received by grace through faith in Jesus Christ, not by our good works.
- ▶ *"Jesus told him, 'I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one can come to the Father except through me.'" John 14:6 (NLT)*
- ▶ *"⁸ God saved you by his grace when you believed. And you can't take credit for this; it is a gift from God. ⁹ Salvation is not a reward for the good things we have done, so none of us can boast about it."* *Ephesians 2:8–9 (NLT)*

WE BELIEVE IN _____.

- ▶ Water baptism is a believer's public declaration of faith in Jesus Christ. Baptism does not save us; we are saved by grace through faith. Baptism is an act of obedience that identifies us with the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus. At Metanoya, we baptize believers by full immersion in water.
- ▶ *"Therefore, go and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit." Matthew 28:19 (NLT)*
- ▶ *"Those who believed what Peter said were baptized and added to the church that day—about 3,000 in all." Acts 2:41 (NLT)*
- ▶ *"For we died and were buried with Christ by baptism. And just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glorious power of the Father, now we also may live new lives." Romans 6:4 (NLT)*

WE BELIEVE IN _____.

- ▶ The Church is the family and Body of Christ, where believers belong, grow, serve, and carry out God's mission together.
 - ▶ *"So now you Gentiles are no longer strangers and foreigners. You are citizens along with all of God's holy people. You are members of God's family." Ephesians 2:19 (NLT)*
 - ▶ *"¹² The human body has many parts, but the many parts make up one whole body. So it is with the body of Christ. ¹³ Some of us are Jews, some are Gentiles, some are slaves, and some are free. But we have all been baptized into one body by one Spirit, and we all share the same Spirit.*
- ¹⁴ Yes, the body has many different parts, not just one part. ¹⁵ If the foot says, "I am not a part of the body because I am not a*

hand,” that does not make it any less a part of the body. ¹⁶ And if the ear says, “I am not part of the body because I am not an eye,” would that make it any less a part of the body? ¹⁷ If the whole body were an eye, how would you hear? Or if your whole body were an ear, how would you smell anything?

¹⁸ But our bodies have many parts, and God has put each part just where he wants it. ¹⁹ How strange a body would be if it had only one part! ²⁰ Yes, there are many parts, but only one body. ²¹ The eye can never say to the hand, “I don’t need you.” The head can’t say to the feet, “I don’t need you.”

²² In fact, some parts of the body that seem weakest and least important are actually the most necessary. ²³ And the parts we regard as less honorable are those we clothe with the greatest care. So we carefully protect those parts that should not be seen, ²⁴ while the more honorable parts do not require this special care. So God has put the body together such that extra honor and care are given to those parts that have less dignity.

²⁵ This makes for harmony among the members, so that all the members care for each other. ²⁶ If one part suffers, all the parts suffer with it, and if one part is honored, all the parts are glad. ²⁷ All of you together are Christ’s body, and each of you is a part of it.” 1 Corinthians 12:12–27 (NLT)

WE BELIEVE IN _____.

- ▶ Jesus will gather His Church to Himself, and believers will be with the Lord forever.
- ▶ “¹⁶ For the Lord himself will come down from heaven with a commanding shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trumpet call of God. First, the believers who have died will rise from their graves. ¹⁷ Then, together with them, we who are still alive and remain on the earth will be caught up in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. Then we will be with the Lord forever.” 1 Thessalonians 4:16–17 (NLT)

WE BELIEVE IN _____.

- ▶ Jesus will return in power and glory as King of Kings and Lord of Lords.
- ▶ *"¹¹ Then I saw heaven opened, and a white horse was standing there. Its rider was named Faithful and True, for he judges fairly and wages a righteous war. ¹² His eyes were like flames of fire, and on his head were many crowns. A name was written on him that no one understood except himself. ¹³ He wore a robe dipped in blood, and his title was the Word of God. ¹⁴ The armies of heaven, dressed in the finest of pure white linen, followed him on white horses. ¹⁵ From his mouth came a sharp sword to strike down the nations. He will rule them with an iron rod. He will release the fierce wrath of God, the Almighty, like juice flowing from a winepress. ¹⁶ On his robe at his thigh was written this title: King of all kings and Lord of all lords." Revelation 19:11–16 (NLT)*

WE BELIEVE IN _____.

- ▶ Those who belong to Jesus have the promise of eternal life with God.
- ▶ *"Don't let your hearts be troubled. Trust in God, and trust also in me. ² There is more than enough room in my Father's home. If this were not so, would I have told you that I am going to prepare a place for you? ³ When everything is ready, I will come and get you, so that you will always be with me where I am." John 14:1–3 (NLT)*
- ▶ *"Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the old heaven and the old earth had disappeared. And the sea was also gone. ² And I saw the holy city, the new Jerusalem, coming down from God out of heaven like a bride beautifully dressed for her husband. ³ I heard a loud shout from the throne, saying, "Look, God's home is now among his people! He will live with them, and they will be his people. God himself will be with them.*

“He will wipe every tear from their eyes, and there will be no more death or sorrow or crying or pain. All these things are gone forever.” Revelation 21:1–4 (NLT)

WHAT DOES THIS MEAN FOR ME?

Today we've answered three questions:

WHERE DID WE COME FROM? | Our Story:

Metanoya was born so people could know Jesus Christ personally.

WHY ARE WE HERE? | Our Mission:

To reach people who are far from God and help them find new life in Jesus Christ.

WHAT DO WE BELIEVE? | Our Beliefs:

We stand on God's Word as the foundational truth of the Christian faith.

Now there's one question for you:



WILL METANOYA SIMPLY BE A CHURCH YOU VISIT, OR WILL IT BECOME A CHURCH FAMILY YOU BELONG TO?



MEMBERSHIP 101 **COMMITMENT**

Tonight isn't the end of your Membership journey. It's the beginning.

I understand the story, mission, and foundational beliefs of Metanoya Church, and I desire to continue discovering what it means to belong to the Metanoya family.

- ☐ **YES, I WANT TO CONTINUE THE MEMBERSHIP JOURNEY MY BAPTISM**

Water baptism is a believer's public declaration of faith in Jesus Christ and an important step of obedience in following Jesus.
— Matthew 28:19; Romans 6:4 (NLT)

- ☐ **YES, I HAVE BEEN BAPTIZED BY IMMERSION** after placing my faith in Jesus Christ.
- ☐ **NO, I HAVE NOT BEEN BAPTIZED YET**, but I am ready to take that next step.
- ☐ **I WOULD LIKE MORE INFORMATION** about water baptism before making that decision.

Name: _____

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

Signature: _____

Closing Prayer

Father, thank You for the lives You have changed through Metanoya and for allowing us to be part of what You're doing. Help us never forget why we exist. Help us love people and continue reaching those who need Jesus. No matter how much You bless this church, help us never forget the one. Use us to reach one more soul.

In Jesus' name Amen.